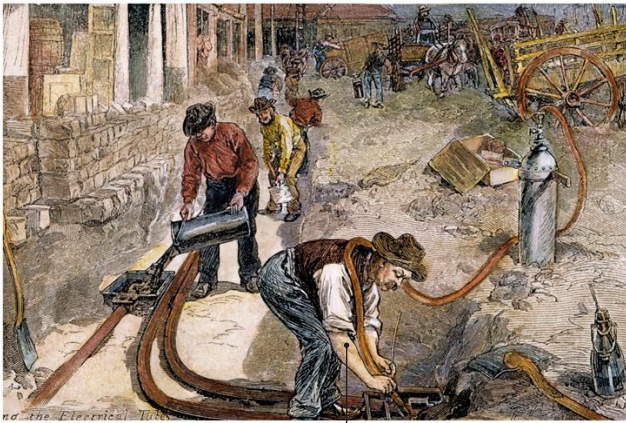


PUBLIC ELECTRICITY SUPPLY

In 1882, the American inventor Thomas Edison launched the first steam-powered electricity-generating station in London. He supplied the surrounding streets and businesses with electric light for a period of three months. Later that year, he opened the Pearl Street Power Station in New York City.

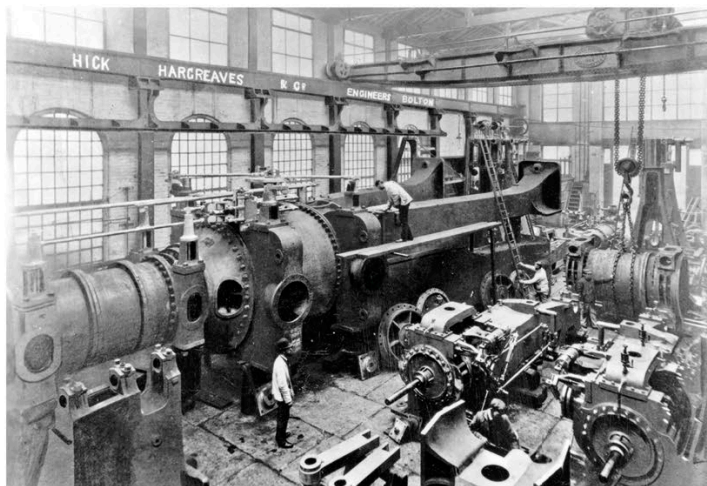
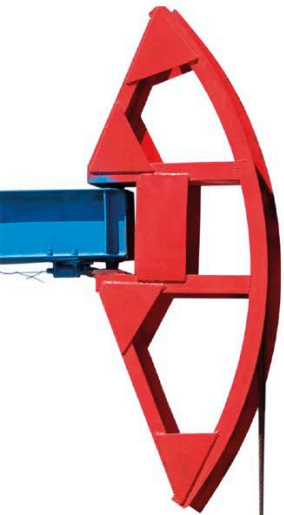
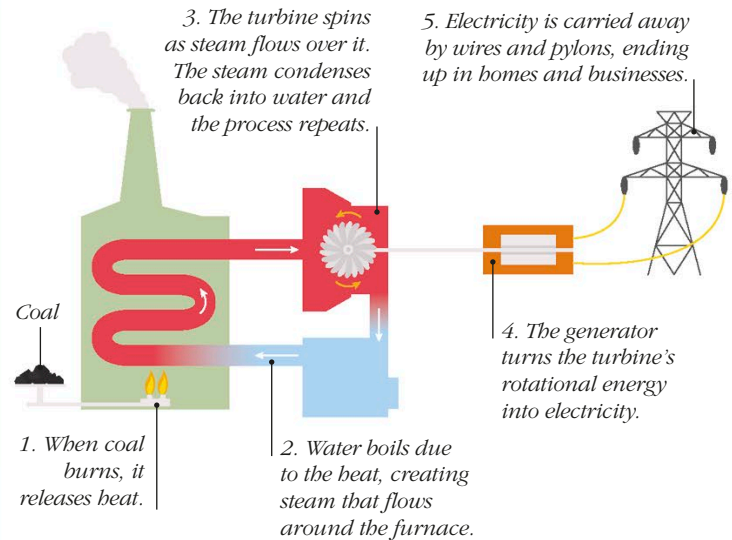


New York City, 1882

Workers test electric cables before laying them in the ground.

GENERATING ELECTRICITY

Early power stations were powered by vast amounts of coal. Lumps of this fuel were fed into huge furnaces to produce the heat required to turn water into steam, which drove the turbines. In turn, this generated electricity. Later, oil replaced coal as this was less polluting.



Deptford Power Station, 1890

POWER STATION

Sebastian de Ferranti was a British engineer and a pioneer in the field of electricity. In 1887, he was hired by the newly formed London Electric Supply Corporation for whom he designed the world's first modern power station, in Deptford, London.

Brokdorf Nuclear Power Plant, Germany



NUCLEAR POWER

In 1923, scientists discovered that "splitting" atoms unleashed tremendous power. In 1951 in the US, a nuclear reactor was used for the first time to generate electricity. In 1954 in Russia, a nuclear power plant became the first to generate electricity for a power grid.



The plunger moves inside the well and brings oil to the surface.